

MODULE 04 · DOMAIN 1 - CLOUD CONCEPTS

The Cloud Adoption Framework

Six perspectives, four domains, four phases. And why AWS wrote it at all.

DOMAIN 1 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT 24% MODULE 4 of 26

Cloud transformations rarely fail for **technical** reasons. They fail organisationally.

Cloud Adoption Framework or Well-Architected?

AWS CAF

How to adopt the cloud

- About the organisation and its readiness
- Used before and during a transformation
- Perspectives, domains and phases
- Audience includes executives and HR

WELL-ARCHITECTED FRAMEWORK

How to build on the cloud

- About a specific workload's design
- Used when designing or reviewing a system
- Six pillars
- Audience is architects and engineers

THE TIEBREAKER

CAF is about the organisation adopting cloud. Well-Architected is about a workload running on it.

The six perspectives

PERSPECTIVE	WHAT IT IS RESPONSIBLE FOR
Business	Making sure cloud investment matches business objectives
People	Culture, skills, training and organisational change
Governance	Managing risk, cost, compliance and programme oversight
Platform	Building the cloud environment and modernising workloads
Security	Confidentiality, integrity and availability of data and workloads
Operations	Running and supporting services to the agreed standard

ON THE EXAM

Six perspectives, forty-seven capabilities in CAF version 3. You need the six names, not the forty-seven.

The business three and the technical three

BUSINESS CAPABILITIES

Business, People, Governance

- Owned by executives, HR and compliance
- Answer: should we, can we, who decides
- Where transformations usually stall
- No AWS service will fix a gap here

TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

Platform, Security, Operations

- Owned by engineering and operations teams
- Answer: how do we build and run it
- Where most study material stops
- Maps onto services you already know

THE TIEBREAKER

If a scenario describes a non-technical obstacle, the answer is one of the business three.

Perspective reverse lookup

IF THE SCENARIO MENTIONS	THE PERSPECTIVE IS
Measuring return on cloud investment, business cases	Business
Training staff, cloud fluency, resistance to change	People
Cost control, risk management, programme oversight	Governance
Building the landing zone, modernising applications	Platform
Identity, controls, incident response, data protection	Security
Monitoring, incident and problem management, service levels	Operations

ON THE EXAM

Training and culture is always People. Cost control and risk is always Governance. Those two carry most of the questions.

The People perspective in detail

- ◆ **It covers culture, not just training.** Moving from waterfall to agile is a People matter.
- ◆ Closing skill gaps, certification paths and cloud fluency programmes all sit here.
- ◆ Organisational change management and staff resistance sit here too.
- ◆ Hiring an AWS partner to do the work does not close a People gap. Your staff still cannot run it.
- ◆ The People perspective is the bridge between business intent and technical delivery.

ON THE EXAM

Any scenario where the obstacle is what people know or how they work is the People perspective.

Governance and Operations, separated

- ◆ **Governance is about control before and around the work.** Cost management, risk, compliance, portfolio decisions.
- ◆ **Operations is about running the result day to day.** Monitoring, incidents, problems, service levels.
- ◆ Governance asks whether we should be spending this. Operations asks whether it is working right now.
- ◆ Governance overlaps with Domain 4 cost tooling. Operations overlaps with the Well-Architected operational excellence pillar.
- ◆ Do not read Operations as security monitoring. Threat detection is the Security perspective.

ON THE EXAM

Should we be doing this, and what will it cost, is Governance. Is it working right now is Operations.

The four transformation domains

- ◆ **Technology.** Migrating and modernising the infrastructure, applications and data.
- ◆ **Process.** Digitising and automating how the business operates.
- ◆ **Organization.** Reorganising teams around products rather than functions.
- ◆ **Product.** Reimagining what the business sells and how it reaches customers.
- ◆ A single initiative usually touches all four at once.

ON THE EXAM

Perspectives are who is responsible. Domains are what is changing. AWS spells the third domain Organization.

The four phases

01

Envision

Show how cloud accelerates business outcomes. Identify and prioritise opportunities.

02

Align

Find capability gaps across the six perspectives. Surface stakeholder concerns.

03

Launch

Deliver pilot initiatives in production and prove incremental value.

04

Scale

Expand the pilots and make sure the expected benefits are actually realised.

ON THE EXAM

Envision prioritises, Align finds gaps, Launch pilots, Scale expands. It loops rather than ending.

Perspectives, domains, phases

EASY TO CONFUSE

They are not alternatives

- Six perspectives: who is responsible
- Four domains: what is changing
- Four phases: where you are in the journey
- All three operate at once

HOW THE EXAM USES THEM

It asks for one layer

- A named group of people means a perspective
- A type of change means a domain
- A point in the timeline means a phase
- Options rarely mix the three

THE TIEBREAKER

Six, four and four. If you can say which layer a question is asking about, the answer follows quickly.

The four business outcomes

- ◆ **Reduced business risk.** Better resilience, security and compliance posture.
- ◆ **Improved environmental, social and governance performance.** Usually shortened to ESG.
- ◆ **Increased revenue.** New products, new markets, faster time to market.
- ◆ **Increased operational efficiency.** Doing the same work with less effort and cost.
- ◆ The exam guide lists these four by name, so treat them as a memorised set.

ON THE EXAM

ESG is the one candidates do not expect. It is named explicitly in the CLF-C02 exam guide.

A logistics company has approved a cloud migration. Six weeks in, progress has stalled. The infrastructure team is comfortable with AWS, but the operations team has never run a cloud environment and is openly resistant, and no training programme exists.

The programme director wants to know which part of the framework this problem belongs to.

Which AWS CAF perspective addresses this?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ☐ A Operations | ☐ B People |
| ☐ C Governance | ☐ D Platform |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which AWS CAF perspective addresses this?

A Operations

The strongest distractor, because the operations team is named. But the gap is skills and attitude, not how services are run.

C Governance

No question of cost, risk or oversight is raised. The programme is already approved.

B People

Missing skills, no training programme, and staff resistance. All three are the People perspective.

D Platform

The infrastructure team is comfortable. The technical build is not what stalled.

THE SIGNAL

The word operations in the stem is bait. The gap described is what people know and how they feel.

A retailer is at the very start of its cloud programme. It has run a facilitated workshop to identify which transformation opportunities would most accelerate its business objectives, and has linked each one to a senior stakeholder and a measurable outcome. It has not yet assessed anyone's skills or built anything.

Which AWS CAF phase is the retailer in?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ☐ A Envision | ☐ B Align |
| ☐ C Launch | ☐ D Scale |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which AWS CAF phase is the retailer in?

- A

Envision
Prioritising opportunities and tying them to stakeholders and measurable outcomes is exactly this phase.
- B

Align
Align is where capability gaps are found. The scenario says no skills assessment has happened.
- C

Launch
Launch means pilots running in production. Nothing has been built.
- D

Scale
Scale expands proven pilots. There are no pilots yet.

THE SIGNAL

Prioritising opportunities against business objectives is Envision. Finding capability gaps is Align.

A bank's cloud programme is under way. Finance is concerned that individual teams can now provision resources without a purchase order, and there is no agreed way to attribute spend to business units or to stop a team exceeding its allocation.

The chief risk officer separately wants assurance that regulatory obligations are being tracked.

Which AWS CAF perspective covers both of these concerns?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ A Business | ☐ B Operations |
| ☐ C Governance | ☐ D Security |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which AWS CAF perspective covers both of these concerns?

A Business

Business is about aligning investment with objectives, not about controlling how spend happens.

C Governance

Cost management and risk and compliance management are both Governance capabilities.

B Operations

Operations runs the services. Neither budget control nor regulatory tracking is an operational task.

D Security

Tempting because a bank and a risk officer are mentioned. But no threat, control or data protection issue is raised.

THE SIGNAL

Cost control and regulatory risk are the two headline Governance capabilities. Both appear here.

A publisher's board asks why it should fund a cloud programme at all. The chief executive summarises four expected benefits.

Fewer outages affecting customers. Lower energy consumption in its reporting. A new subscription product it could not build before. And fewer staff hours spent on manual releases.

How many of the four are named CAF business outcomes?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ A One of them | ☐ B Two of them |
| ☐ C Three of them | ☐ D All four |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How many of the four are named CAF business outcomes?

- A

 One of them
Undercounts. Each of the four benefits maps onto a different named outcome.
- B

 Two of them
Undercounts. ESG and increased revenue are both easy to miss in this list.
- C

 Three of them
The near miss. Usually people drop the energy consumption item, not realising ESG is named.
- D

 All four
Outages maps to reduced business risk, energy to ESG, the new product to increased revenue, manual hours to operational efficiency.

THE SIGNAL

Fewer outages, lower energy use, a new product, less manual effort. One for each of the four named outcomes.

What to carry out of this module

- ◆ **CAF is about the organisation. Well-Architected is about a workload.**
- ◆ **Six perspectives, four domains, four phases.** Identify the layer first and the answer follows.
- ◆ Training and culture is always People. Cost control and risk is always Governance.
- ◆ Envision prioritises opportunities. Align finds capability gaps. That pair is worth separating.
- ◆ A named team in the stem is not a named perspective. Read the gap, not the job title.

ON THE EXAM

The four outcomes are risk, ESG, revenue and operational efficiency. Memorise them; the guide names them.